



Series A Fundraise Media Strategy

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TODAY'S AGENDA

- 1. About**
- 2. Timeline**
- 3. Reporter Targets**
- 4. Event Analysis**
- 5. Cost Structure**

Monica Vendituoli



About Me

- Spent five years as a reporter covering crime and business (Not at the same time)
- Stories have been picked up by the **Washington Post** and **Associated Press**
- Work has won awards from the **Colorado Press Association** and the **North Carolina Press Association**
- Spent 1.5 years as a public relations professional, securing coverage for clients in **Bloomberg, Inc. Magazine, and Forbes**, among other publications
- **Duke University Fuqua School of Business MBA Candidate** (Core courses completed)
- Full-disclosure - Begin marketing internship at Microsoft on May 23, so the ***last day I can work is May 20***

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Project Goals



- **Secure media coverage** for HomePace Series A in at least one top-tier media outlet
- **Provide media training** for co-founders and anyone else connected to the launch, such as Lennar representatives, investors, and customers, if desired
- **Provide framework for earned media relations strategy** moving forward and provide additional feedback on avenues to establish legitimacy for firm, such as through paid media, social media, thought leadership, and partnerships

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Project Timeline Overview

(Assuming starting week of 3/28/22)

	Week of 3/28	Week of 4/4	Week of 4/11	Week of 4/18	Week of 4/25	Week of 5/2
Write press release and pitch drafts						
Conduct media training						
Finalize press release and pitch draft						
Pitch press release exclusives to media						
Interviews						
Send news release across wire						
Provide feedback and next steps						

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Week of 3/28

- Email following for quotes for press release:
 - Co-Founders
 - Lennar representative Investors, such as venture capital firm representatives
 - Quote from customer (Not required, but would be great)
- Purchase Ring lights for interviews
- Set-up freelancer email address
- Find out availability for 5 potential spokespeople for 4/18 and beyond
- Write draft of press release by 4/1 with blanks for 5 potential quotes above
- Send Co-Founders questions on company vision and personal backgrounds
- Meet virtually with Co-Founders to get goals/vision of company (Not required, but would be great)
- Set-up Qwoted, HARO, and Cision PR Newswire accounts

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Week of 4/4

- Write pitch to send to selected reporters
- Receive quotes back by 4/6
- Send press release and pitches to attorney for approval by 4/8
- Media training with co-founders/others
- Scan for possible HARO and Qwoted opportunities

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Week of 4/11

- Receive press release and pitch approval from attorney by 4/15 or ASAP
- Conduct media training with co-founders/others
- Finalizing availability for interviews
- Scan for possible HARO and Qwoted opportunities

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Week of 4/18 and 4/25

- Pitch exclusives and embargo'd press releases
- Set up interviews
- Scan for possible HARO and Qwoted opportunities

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Week of 5/2

- Send out official news release on Cision PR Newswire
- Provide reporter feedback and vision for media moving forward
- Scan for possible HARO and Qwoted opportunities

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

National Reporter Targets

Outlet name	Reporter names
CNBC	Names withheld
Wall Street Journal	Names withheld
Bloomberg	Names withheld
Business Insider	Names withheld
CNN	Names withheld
TechCrunch	Names withheld
Forbes	Names withheld
Fortune	Names withheld
New York Times	Names withheld

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Specialized Reporter Targets

Outlet name	Reporter names
WTFintech!	Names withheld
Protocol	Names withheld
Investment News	Names withheld
FinLedger	Names withheld
Housing Wire	Names withheld
Morning Brew	Names withheld
Axios	Names withheld

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Local Reporter Targets

Outlet name	Reporter names
Triangle Business Journal	Names withheld
News & Observer	Names withheld
WRAL	Names withheld
Puget Sound Business Journal	Names withheld
Seattle Times	Names withheld
KOMO-TV	Names withheld
Salt Lake Tribune	Names withheld
Deseret News	Names withheld

[About](#)[Timeline](#)[Reporter
Targets](#)[Event
Analysis](#)[Cost
Structure](#)

News Event Strengths



- Startup focuses on trending topic of national importance - housing
- Series A funding provides strong breaking news hook
- Series A funding includes investment from Lennar, the second-largest homebuilder in the U.S.
- Co-Founders with big-name backgrounds - Blackstone, Haas School of Business MBA, Penn State MBA, Series 63 & Series 7 certified
- Diverse Co-Founders - Woman, Veteran (News directors are increasingly looking for reporters to increase diversity)

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure

Potential Pitfalls



LAND USE

Advocates Worry Blackstone Sale Will Take Affordable Housing Crisis From Bad to Worse

The planned sale of 66 apartment buildings to the New York-based Blackstone Group highlights both the vulnerability of naturally affordable housing and the lack of requirement for owners to notify local governments of plans to unload properties.

by Lisa Halverstadt and Jesse Marx May 18, 2021



- World events - WW3 break out or other major news (think pandemic, George Floyd protest)
- General decline in reporters
- Housing and private equity concerns
- Slightly complicated topic
- Series A funding rounds that are larger than \$7 million

About

Timeline

Reporter
Targets

Event
Analysis

Cost
Structure



Questions/Comments